

US equities slip as yields rise, energy leads gains

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read • Topics: Macro • Geopolitics • Earnings

TL;DR

The major U.S. indices closed lower on Friday, with the **S&P 500** down **-0.45%** at 7,585.73 and the **Nasdaq 100** off **-0.65%** at 28,937.84. Higher-than-expected 10-year Treasury yields (5.00%) and a firm-handed Fed stance pressured growth-oriented stocks.

Energy ETFs rallied, with **XLE** up **+2.17%** on a rebound in crude, while technology and financials lagged. Investors will watch upcoming earnings from **AAPL** and **MSFT** for clues on demand.

US Session Recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,585.73	-0.45%	
Dow Jones	52,093.11	-0.63%	
Nasdaq 100	28,937.84	-0.65%	
Russell 2000	2,870.29	-0.76%	
VIX	17.20	+0.58%	volatility modestly higher
10Y Yield	5.00	+0.71%	peak since 2023
WTI Crude	104.78	-0.99%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
NVDA	212.17	+0.57%
META	670.24	+0.70%
JPM	352.49	+0.67%
AMZN	248.42	-2.02%
MSFT	497.12	-1.64%

Spotlight

Apple's Q3 earnings released after market close showed revenue of 122.5 billion, up **+3.2%** YoY, but iPhone sales slipped **-1.8%**. The company raised its FY2026 guidance to 530 billion, citing services growth.

METRIC	VALUE
Revenue	122.5 bn
YoY growth	+3.2%
iPhone sales	-1.8%
FY guidance	530 bn

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year Treasury yield: 5.00% (+0.71%)
- Today's releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, Core PCE 03:30, Retail sales 04:30

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China's manufacturing PMI slipped to 48.9, indicating contraction.
- Eurozone inflation held at 2.3% YoY, supporting ECB's steady-rate stance.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:00 Sep 17	MSFT	Cloud revenue growth, margin trends
03:30 Sep 17	GOOGL	Ad spend recovery, AI licensing
04:45 Sep 18	TSLA	Production volumes, pricing strategy
05:15 Sep 18	JPM	Net interest income, loan growth

Stocks worth watching

- **AAPL** – earnings beat, guidance lift may spark rally.
- **NVDA** – AI demand remains strong despite modest price move.
- **XLE** – energy sector upside on crude rebound.
- **XLF** – banks under pressure from higher rates.
- **META** – ad-revenue recovery hints at upside.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- 10-year yield breaches 5.10%, tightening financing.
- Unexpected CPI surprise above 3.2% YoY.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East.

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Energy prices surge above \$110, lifting XLE.
- Strong AI earnings from **NVDA** or **AMD**.
- Positive Fed commentary on slower rate hikes.

Sources

SOURCES

[Reuters — US Markets](#)

[Bloomberg — S&P 500](#)

[CNBC — Earnings Calendar](#)

[FRED — 10-Year Treasury Yield](#)

[SEC — Company Filings](#)